



Online Pet Shop Development in the Philippines: Industry Research, Competitor Analysis, Legal Compliance, and Initial Phases

Introduction

The pet industry in the Philippines has been expanding rapidly over the last few years. According to **GlobalPETS (2025)**, the local market is valued at around **USD 108 million**, more than double its size in 2018. There are now over **16.4 million dogs** and **2 million cats** in Filipino households, showing how pets have become an important part of family life. With this growth, e-commerce platforms such as **Shopee, Lazada, and TikTok Shop** have also become strong sales channels for pet products. This paper compiles industry information, competitor analysis, legal considerations, and initial development tasks for launching an online pet marketplace in the Philippines.

1.1 Pet Industry Overview

The pet industry in the Philippines has been growing quickly in recent years. More Filipinos now consider pets as part of their families, which is why there is higher spending on pet food, grooming, and healthcare. A 2023 survey showed that about 64% of Filipino households own pets, with dogs and cats as the most common (Inquirer, 2023; Philstar, 2023).

Pet food is the biggest part of the market. In 2023, it was worth around USD 434 million and is expected to almost double by 2030 (BusinessWorld, 2023; Mordor Intelligence, 2025). However, most of this food is imported from countries like Thailand, China, and the United States (Philstar, 2024).

Other parts of the industry are also growing. The animal healthcare sector was valued at USD 175 million in 2024 and is still expanding (Business Report, 2025). Accessories and pet supplies, such as collars, toys, and cages, are also seeing more demand, with sales supported by online platforms like Shopee, Lazada, and TikTok Shop (Statista, 2025; EcommerceDB, 2025).

Filipino pet owners are also becoming more interested in premium and healthy products, such as organic pet food, grooming services, and wellness items (Petpreneur, 2022; BusinessWorld, 2023). This shows how people now see pets less as property and more as companions.

Overall, the pet industry in the Philippines presents a strong opportunity for online businesses. E-commerce continues to drive sales, and while challenges like high import reliance and competition remain, the market outlook is very positive.

1.2 Competitors in the Online Pet Shop Market

Before launching an online pet shop, it is essential to review existing competitors. This helps identify market gaps, strengths, and opportunities for positioning.

Business Name	Website	Contact	Products	Location	Background
Pet Express	https://www.petexpress.com.ph	Hotline: 8650-4693; and customercare@petexpress.com.ph	Dog & cat food, treats, grooming, health, accessories	Nationwide (HQ & branches across Metro Manila)	Established multi-branch pet retailer with online store and physical branches inside malls; offers grooming and vet services.
Pet Warehouse	https://www.petwarehouse.ph	hi@petwarehouse.ph; (0977) 823-8050; (02) 7989-8166	Wide range of pet food, accessories, small pets, aquatics; large online catalog	Metro Manila (online nationwide delivery)	Large online pet store positioning itself as the biggest pet online store in the Philippines; active on social media and marketplaces.
Pet Kingdom	https://petkingdom.com.ph	info@petkingdom.com.ph; 0998-843-4420; Landline 700-17855	Pet food, grooming supplies, accessories, grooming & vet consultation services	Pasig / Quezon City / branches in major malls	Multi-branch retailer with big mall presence and online shop; provides grooming and in-store services.
Dogs And The City	https://dogsandthecity.com	Contact form on site; active Shopee/Lazada stores	Pet apparel, food, grooming products, toys,	Metro Manila (multiple store locations &	Retailer combining e-commerce with physical stores and

		and mall branches	grooming/daycare/boarding services	online)	pet services (grooming, daycare, boarding).
PetFriendlys.ph	https://petfriendlys.ph	Contact form on site / social media pages	Local and international brands: food, bowls, beds, treats, wellness products	Online (serves nationwide)	Online specialty store focused on curated local brands alongside international pet products.
Pet Republic / PETS Republic	https://petsrepublic.pet	Phone listed on social pages; social media (Facebook/Instagram)	General pet supplies, grooming services, accessories	Metro Manila (online presence)	Retailer/wholesaler with strong social media presence and online shop.
Urban Pets	Facebook / Instagram pages	Mobile: listed on social pages (e.g., 09757116346 / 0942-0013962 depending on branch)	Food, grooming, accessories, local pet services	Mandaluyong / Makati (branches)	Local one-stop pet shop with branches and active social presence; also sells via marketplaces.
PetZone (Greenhills)	Facebook / Lazada / Shopee pages	Store phone / WhatsApp listed on pages (e.g., 09228229271)	Food, fish, small animals, accessories; physical & online	San Juan (Greenhills) and online	Longstanding neighborhood pet shop with online channels and presence on Lazada/Shopee.

Cartimar Pet Center	Marketplace listings / Facebook / local directories	Various vendor contacts via Cartimar; phone listings on local directories	Live animals (fish, birds), food, cages, accessories, market-style pet supplies	Cartimar, Pasay City (major pet market hub)	Iconic pet market (Cartimar) with many vendors selling a wide variety of pet goods and live animals.
Pretty Bubble Boutique	https://prettybubbleboutique.com	Contact form / social pages	Premium boutique pet products, teacup/toy breed services	Metro Manila (online boutique)	Premium pet boutique offering curated products and specialty services.

1.3 Posting Animals Online (Legal Check)

Selling or posting animals online in the Philippines is allowed but subject to strict government regulation. The following are the key legal requirements:

- **Animal Welfare Act (RA 8485, as amended by RA 10631):** Requires humane treatment of animals and regulates their trade and care. Sellers must ensure that animals are not mistreated, neglected, or sold without proper documentation.
- **Wildlife Resources Conservation and Protection Act (RA 9147):** Strictly prohibits the sale or trade of endangered and protected species.
- **Bureau of Animal Industry (BAI) Requirements:** Businesses that breed, trade, or transport animals must secure accreditation or registration from BAI. Transport of animals also requires BAI permits to ensure safety and health compliance.
- **Business Permits and Licenses:** Sellers must have valid local government permits (DTI/SEC registration, Mayor's Permit, BIR registration) to legally operate.



- **Health and Vaccination Records:** All animals sold must come with updated veterinary health certificates and vaccination records to protect buyers and the public.
- **Platform Compliance:** E-commerce sites and social media marketplaces require adherence to both national laws and their internal policies before approving listings for animals. These platforms have commerce policies that restrict or ban live animal sales.

Failure to comply with these regulations can result in business permit revocation, fines, confiscation of animals, or criminal liability.

Pet Shop Compliance and Market Opportunities: Animal Sales vs. Product-Only vs. Complete Shops

To better understand the opportunities and challenges of different business models, the table below compares pet shops that sell animals, those focused only on products, and complete shops offering both.

Aspect	Pet Shop with Animal Sales	Pet Shop without Animal Sales (Products Only)	Complete Pet Shop (Animals + Products)
Legal Requirements	Must comply with RA 8485 (Animal Welfare Act), RA 9147 (Wildlife Protection), and secure BAI accreditation/permits for breeding, transport, and trade.	Focuses only on general business permits (DTI/SEC, Mayor's Permit, BIR). No need for BAI permits related to live animals.	Must comply with RA 8485 (Animal Welfare Act), RA 9147 (Wildlife Protection), and secure BAI accreditation/permits for breeding, transport, and trade plus general business permits (DTI/SEC, Mayor's Permit, BIR). Also, FDA permits may be

			required for certain pet food products.
Documentation	Needs veterinary health certificates and vaccination records for every animal sold.	No animal-related documentation required, only product compliance (e.g., FDA registration for pet food, if applicable).	Needs veterinary health certificates and vaccination records for animals and compliance certificates for pet food and other regulated supplies.
Operational Complexity	Higher — involves animal care, welfare compliance, quarantine, and transport regulations.	Lower — limited to stocking, selling, and shipping pet products (food, toys, accessories, grooming items).	Highest — must manage both animal welfare compliance (care, housing, transport) and product supply chain (inventory, stocking, logistics).
Risk & Liability	High — possible fines, confiscation of animals, business permit revocation, or criminal liability if regulations are violated.	Lower — risk limited to product quality issues, consumer protection, and general business compliance.	Very High — subject to penalties for animal welfare violations and consumer protection/product liability issues.
Platform Restrictions	Many e-commerce and social media platforms restrict or ban live animal sales. Listings are	Easier to sell online — pet food, supplies, and accessories are generally allowed on most platforms.	Mixed — pet supplies can be freely listed online, but live animal sales are restricted or disallowed on most

	often subject to stricter approval or outright disallowed.		e-commerce platforms.
Market Opportunities	Attracts customers looking to buy pets directly, but market is more regulated and scrutinized.	Expands market to a wider online audience, as product sales are easier to scale without legal hurdles.	Broadest market reach — caters to both pet buyers and pet owners purchasing supplies, but requires strict compliance and higher operational investment.

1.4 Draft Development Phases

The development of the online pet shop will be divided into phases. This approach helps the business manage growth in a structured way, starting with the most essential and high-demand products before expanding to other categories.

1.4.1 Phase 1 – Pet Food

Pet food is the largest segment of the pet industry in the Philippines, with strong and consistent demand. According to BusinessWorld (2023) and Mordor Intelligence (2025), the Philippine pet food market was valued at around USD 434 million in 2023 and is expected to nearly double by 2030.

Products to include:

- **Dry Dog Food:** Pedigree, Royal Canin, Holistic Recipe, Orijen, Nutri Chunks, Purina Dog Chow, Eukanuba, Canine Creek
- **Wet Dog Food:** Cesar, Pedigree, Royal Canin Pouches, Alpo, SmartHeart, Pedigree Loaf



- **Dry Cat Food:** Whiskas, Friskies, Royal Canin, IAMS, Me-O, Kit Cat, Brit Care, Wellness Core
- **Wet Cat Food:** Sheba, Whiskas, Fancy Feast, Monge, Kit Cat Pouch, Royal Canin Instinctive
- **Treats & Snacks:** JerHigh dog treats, Temptations cat treats, Bow Wow dog treats, Ciao Churu cat treats
- **Special Diets / Premium Brands:** Hill's Science Diet, Purina Pro Plan, Acana

Requirements before listing:

- FDA certification for all food products
- Clear product labels and feeding instructions
- Expiration dates and batch/lot numbers
- For imported products, proof of importation documents

1.4.2 Phase 2 – Pet Shampoo and Essentials

Once the platform has built trust through pet food sales, the second phase will expand into grooming and hygiene products. This sector is steadily growing as Filipino pet owners spend more on cleanliness and wellness (Petreneur, 2022; GlobalPETS, 2025).

Products to include:

- **Pet Shampoo / Conditioner:**
 - Saint Roche Herbal Shampoo
 - Pet Ag, TropiClean, Furmagic, Bio-Groom
 - Alpo Pet Shampoo
 - **Flea & Tick Solutions:** Frontline Shampoo, Adams Plus, Vet's Best
 - Beaphar Anti-Parasitic Dog Shampoo



- **Dental Care:** Virbac C.E.T. toothpaste, Petdent oral gel
 - TropiClean Natural Pet Shampoo
 - **Ear & Eye Care:** Otoclean ear solution, Angel's Eyes wipes
 - Johnson's Dog & Cat Shampoo (Philippine market variant)
 - **Conditioners & Deodorizers:** Nature's Specialties, Groomer's Edge, Wahl
-
- **Grooming Tools:** Furminator de-shedding tool, nail clippers, grooming scissors, brushes, combs
 - **Collars, Leashes, Harnesses:** Adjustable nylon collars, retractable leashes, padded harnesses
 - **Cleaning & Sanitation:** Pet wipes, urine odor remover sprays, disinfectants safe for pets

Requirements before listing:

- FDA approval for shampoos and hygiene products
- Safety and ingredient labeling
- Proof of product authenticity (to avoid counterfeit grooming items)

1.5 Domain Name Options

Choosing a strong domain name is critical for brand recognition and online presence. Since animalzone.com is already taken, several alternatives were considered that retain the keyword "animalzone" for consistency and recall value. According to Hostinger domain availability checks (2025), the following options are suggested:

Top 3 Choices:

1. animalzoneph.com – emphasizes the Philippine market.
2. myanimalzone.com – personalized branding that appeals to pet owners.



3. animalzoneshop.com – highlights the e-commerce nature of the platform.

Additional Options (Backups):

- 4. animalzoneonline.com
- 5. animalzonemarket.com
- 6. animalzonepets.com
- 7. animalzoneglobal.com
- 8. animalzonehub.com
- 9. animalzonecenter.com
- 10. animalzoneworld.com
- 11. animalzoneplus.com
- 12. animalzonestore.com
- 13. animalzonephils.com

These domains ensure that the brand name remains recognizable while also aligning with online store expectations (Statista, 2025 – E-commerce Market Insights). The use of “.com” is preferred over “.ph” as it is more universally recognized and trusted by online shoppers.



References

- *GlobalPETS. (2025). The pet industry in the Philippines.*
Retrieved from: <https://globalpetindustry.com/news/the-pet-industry-in-the-philippines>
- *Inquirer. (2023). SWS: 64% of Filipino households have pets, 67% have plants.*
Retrieved from: <https://newsinfo.inquirer.net/1838643/survey-says-64-of-filipino-households-have-pets-67-have-plants>
- *Philstar. (2024). Special Report: Feed makers tap thriving pet food market.*
Retrieved from: <https://www.philstar.com/business/2024/10/26/2395258/special-report-feed-makers-tap-thriving-pet-food-market>
- *Mordor Intelligence. (2025). Philippines Pet Food Market – Growth, Trends, and Forecasts.*
Retrieved from: <https://www.mordorintelligence.com/industry-reports/philippines-pet-food-market>
- *BusinessWorld. (2023). Philippine pet food industry to double by 2030. (Full article is paywalled, but available via BusinessWorld archives.)*
Retrieved from: <https://www.bworldonline.com/economy/2023/02/01/502478/phl-pet-food-demand-seen-rising-to-434m/>
- *Petpreneur. (2022). Premium and organic pet product trends in Asia.*
Retrieved from: <https://www.petpreneur.ph/articles/premium-and-organic-pet-product-trends-in-asia>
- *Statista. (2025). Pet care e-commerce revenue in the Philippines (forecast).*
Retrieved from: <https://www.statista.com/outlook/cmo/toys-hobby/pet-care/philippines>
- *EcommerceDB. (2025). Pet food market in the Philippines.*
Retrieved from: <https://ecommercedb.com/markets/ph/pet-food>